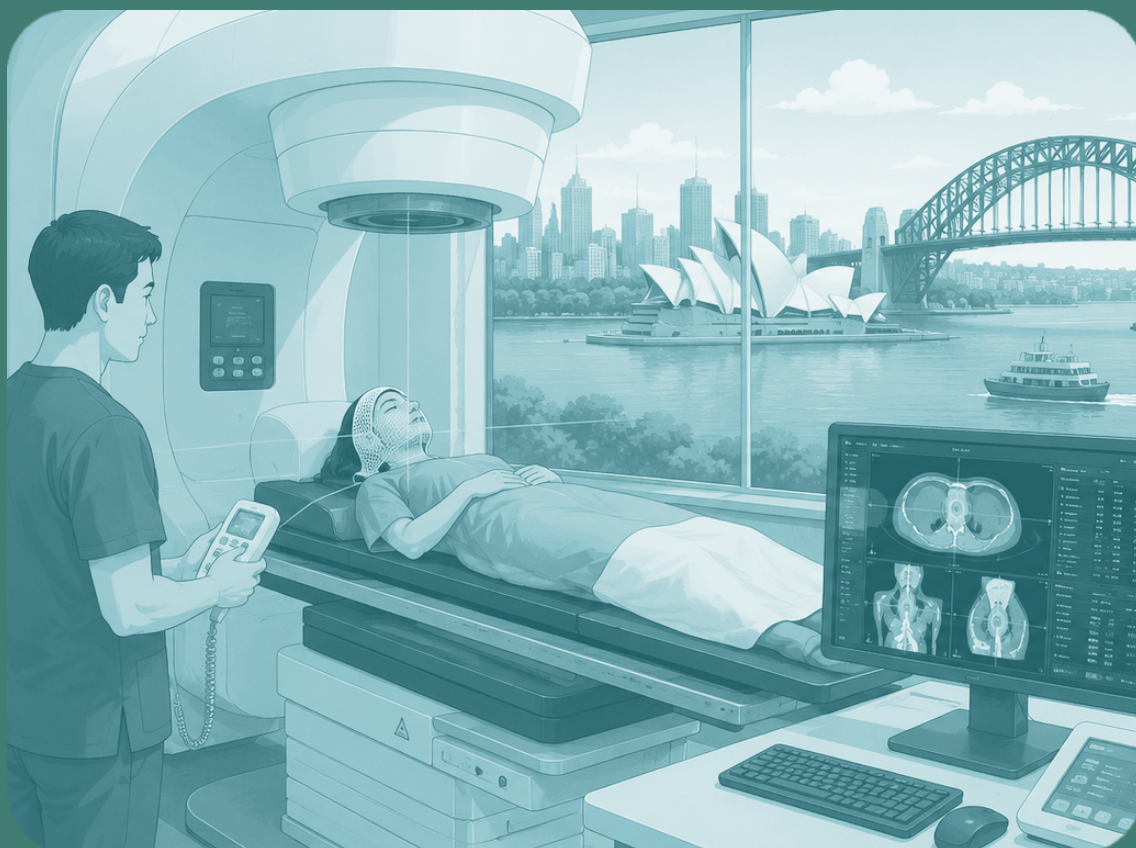


AUSTRALIA RESOURCE CENTRE

Radiation Therapist Registration Guide

Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia (Ahpra)

Your complete guide to registering as a radiation therapist in Australia
— MRPBA registration, explained in plain English for internationally
qualified practitioners.



WELCOME

Welcome to your registration guide

For an internationally qualified radiation therapist, the credential that lets you practise in Australia is registration with the Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia (MRPBA), through Ahpra. Radiation therapist is a protected title under the National Law, so you must hold registration before you can work.

There are two separate processes. Registration is what lets you practise. Separately, for certain skilled-migration visas, you may need a migration skills assessment — for radiation therapists this is carried out by ASMIRT. On an employer-sponsored visa a skills assessment generally isn't required just to register. Either way, registration is the step to lead with.

How to use this guide

Read it once from start to finish to understand the shape of the journey, then keep it nearby and return to each section as you reach it. It's a handbook, not a leaflet.

An important note. This guide complements, not replaces, the official guidance published by the Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia. The Board sets the rules and makes all registration decisions; where there is ever any difference, the Board's own published requirements always take precedence. Ethicare supports and guides you — and, as your recruitment partner, helps secure the role and sponsorship — but we do not make registration decisions on the Board's behalf.

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SECTION 01

Understanding the Board & the scope

The Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia (MRPBA), through Ahpra, registers diagnostic radiographers, radiation therapists and nuclear medicine technologists. Its role is to protect the public by ensuring practitioners are suitably trained, qualified and safe to practise.

Radiation therapist is one of three separate divisions, each with its own registration. You register specifically in the radiation therapist division — a single registration does not let you practise across divisions.

Two things are separate and you need both: MRPBA registration (which lets you practise) and, in most states, a state radiation use licence (which lets you operate radiation-producing equipment). They are issued by different bodies.

Registration lets you practise; a state radiation use licence lets you use radiation. You need both.

SECTION 02

Registration vs migration

Two processes run in parallel but are entirely separate: registration with the MRPBA, and — for certain skilled-migration visas — a migration skills assessment. Success in one does not guarantee the other.

For radiation therapists the migration skills assessment is carried out by ASMIRT (the Australian Society of Medical Imaging and Radiation Therapy), the gazetted assessing authority for this profession.

Lead with registration. On an employer-sponsored 482 visa an ASMIRT assessment generally isn't required just to register — confirm your visa route with your employer or a registered migration adviser.

Lead with MRPBA registration. The ASMIRT skills assessment, where a visa needs it, is separate.

SECTION 03

Is your qualification recognised?

The Board recognises a qualification it considers substantially equivalent to an approved Australian qualification. For radiation therapy there are comparable-regulator routes that can make this straightforward.

Programs approved by the HCPC in the UK (for therapy radiographers) and by CORU in Ireland (for radiation therapists), from 2010 onwards, are recognised — as are NZMRTB-accredited New Zealand programs. Your qualification must match the approved program exactly (institution, title, division and award year).

If your qualification isn't covered that way, there are two further routes: an individual assessment of your qualification, or — if you hold a relevant qualification in a division of registration — demonstrating you've passed the CAMRT (Canada) or NZMRTB (New Zealand) exam. Check the Board's 'Is my qualification recognised' page for the current position.

Check the Board's qualification page first — HCPC/CORU recognition is the fast lane for radiation therapy.

SECTION 04

Qualification assessment (if required)

Where the Board assesses your qualification, it looks at whether your program is substantially equivalent to, or based on similar competencies as, an approved Australian radiation therapy qualification.

Expect it to weigh the educational level (comparable, at minimum, to an Australian Bachelor degree), the accreditation and quality assurance of your program, and whether the core radiation-therapy competencies are covered — treatment planning, simulation and pre-treatment imaging, and patient set-up and reproducibility.

If there are gaps, the outcome may direct you to the national MRP examination or to supervised practice before general registration. The assessment is individual, so a complete, well-evidenced submission matters.

The Board checks equivalence to the Australian radiation-therapy standard — evidence your competencies clearly.

SECTION 05

English language

All applicants must meet the Board's English Language Skills Registration Standard. If English isn't your first language, or your training wasn't taught and assessed entirely in English, you'll provide an approved test result.

Requirements and accepted tests are reviewed periodically, so confirm the current accepted tests, scores and any exemptions against the Board's English-language standard before booking anything. The UK and Ireland are among the countries that may support an exemption — confirm what applies to you.

Time any test so the result is still valid when your application reaches the Board — sitting it too early risks it expiring before you submit.

Meet the Board's English standard; confirm the current tests and exemptions before booking.

SECTION 06

The national MRP examination

Depending on your assessment outcome, you may need to sit the National Medical Radiation Practice examination before general registration. Applicants recognised via a comparable regulator are generally exempt; others may need to sit it.

Where it applies, the exam has a common Part A plus a division-specific Part B, set in the Australian context — radiation safety legislation, the Board's professional capabilities, and cultural safety. It's held several times a year.

Confirm whether the exam applies to you as part of your assessment outcome, and prepare against the Board's published exam reading and resources list.

Comparable-regulator applicants are usually exempt; otherwise confirm and prepare in context.

SECTION 07

Your supporting documents

A clean, certified documentation pack is the single biggest factor within your control on timing. You'll generally assemble certified proof of identity (with evidence of any name change), your radiation therapy qualification and full academic transcript, and evidence of supervised clinical training where required.

You'll also need your registration history and a Certificate of Good Standing from each authority you're registered with (current), an up-to-date CV detailing roles, dates and responsibilities, and certified translations of any non-English documents supplied with the certified original.

Present it like a professional portfolio: certified copies (not copies of certified copies), clean high-resolution scans, and consistent naming. A well-organised application is assessed faster than a disorganised one containing exactly the same facts.

Certify it correctly the first time and keep the pack consistent — organisation drives timing.

SECTION 08

Applying, licensing & starting

You apply to Ahpra / the MRPBA using the relevant application form, selecting the radiation therapist division, and pay the application/registration fee (non-refundable — confirm current figures on the Board's fees page). Respond promptly to any Board queries; incomplete applications are the most common cause of delay.

Once registration is granted you're cleared to practise, but in most states you must also obtain a state radiation use licence before operating radiation-producing equipment — licensed separately by each state or territory.

Many Australian employers expect registration to be in place (or well underway) before you start. As a matter of good practice, don't make irreversible moves — resigning or relocating — until your registration eligibility is confirmed.

Register with the MRPBA, add your state radiation licence, then start — in that order.

HOW ETHICARE WILL SUPPORT YOU

You don't have to navigate this alone

If you choose to partner with Ethicare, we'll support you from first enquiry through securing your radiation therapy role, MRPBA registration and relocation to your first day at work — with a single point of contact, honest guidance, and help at every stage. We support and guide you through the process; the registration decision always rests with the Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia.

READY TO BEGIN?

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